

Bob Summerwill

Software Engineering Leader

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Thirty years in games, platform engineering and distributed systems: fifteen at Electronic Arts on FIFA, NBA, NHL and the first EA SPORTS UFC; six as Executive Director of a nonprofit, line-managing a team of up to ten across engineering, communications, events and finance; and recent hands-on AI-assisted development work. Happiest growing engineers, with the technical depth to earn their trust. Looking to lead an engineering team in Vancouver.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **People leadership:** Line-managed, hired and mentored the ETC Cooperative's whole staff for six years; mentored engineers and interviewed candidates in every EA role from 2003; technical leadership alongside line managers at EA at every scale, from FIFA online lead and Orca CM (three sub-leads, about fifteen engineers) through EATech, the FIFA Advance team and EA Canada studio-wide to TABU and the EA SPORTS label.
- **Technical strategy and tooling:** Fifteen years of build, tooling and architecture strategy at EA, from FIFA's Perforce migration and the Xbox 360 launch-title build system to company-wide configuration management, studio-wide package tracking and the EA SPORTS Architecture Council; cross-team, cross-studio and cross-company collaboration projects throughout from 2002.
- **Distributed systems and open source:** Core developer on the Ethereum Foundation's C++ client (657 commits); lead architect at the Enterprise Ethereum Alliance launch; six years funding and coordinating Ethereum Classic client teams through seven network upgrades; drove STRATO's Apache-2.0 release in 2026.
- **AI-assisted development:** In 2025–26 built AI-assisted engineering workflows and an MCP server at BlockApps and helped the team adopt them.

EXPERIENCE

BlockApps STRATO · Head of Ecosystem · Vancouver / Brooklyn **Jan 2025 – Jul 2026**

Ecosystem leadership and AI adoption for STRATO, BlockApps' Haskell-based, Ethereum-compatible platform.

- Public face of the project in the Ethereum ecosystem: EthCC[9], ETHDenver 2026 (Museum of Ethereum), community programs and launch outreach.
- Drove the Apache-2.0 open-source release of STRATO into an independent GitHub organisation (strato-net); credited by the company's co-founder at the March 2026 launch.
- Built AI-assisted engineering tools and helped the team adopt them: a multi-agent workflow that triages, fixes and reviews GitHub issues (Claude Code and Codex); Griphook, an MCP server exposing platform operations to AI assistants; and transcription/diarisation tooling (WhisperX, pyannote) with upstream PRs.

ETC Cooperative · Executive Director & Secretary · Vancouver / remote team **Jan 2019 – Dec 2024**

- Ran the nonprofit that funded and coordinated Ethereum Classic client development: the legal entity, direction and budget (annual expenditure reaching US\$1.9M), and line management of all staff, up to ten at peak, across software engineering, website development, marketing and communications, finance, and the production of three conferences; published annual retrospectives and financials from 2020.
- Owned recruiting, interviews, hiring and compensation across the staff, with ongoing performance feedback and support for training and professional development; directly managed three engineers for four years.
- Led two restructurings after the principal funder ended support, preserving priority engineering capability.
- Funded and coordinated two independent client teams through seven network-wide upgrades.
- Vice-chair of the EEA Technical Specification Working Group from 2020; joined Hyperledger.

Ethereum Foundation · ConsenSys / EEA · Engineering, architecture and standards roles **2016 – 2018**

- **Ethereum Foundation, 2016:** Core C++ client developer; led the codebase consolidation and the proposed Apache-2.0 relicensing; cross-platform build, release and CI; 657 client commits plus Homestead documentation.
- **ConsenSys / Enterprise Ethereum Alliance, 2016–2017:** Lead architect at the 2017 launch (30 founding members); presented the roadmap; secretary of the technical working group and set up its first working groups.
- **2017–2018:** Sweetbridge (principal developer); Quantfury (blockchain lead); Varro (co-founder and CTO).

TD Securities, DevOps Solutions Architect, Toronto (Apr – Oct 2015): OpenStack migration and Atlassian tooling.

Independent and contract development, Vancouver (2014 – 2015): Sony / PlayStation programming consultant (Feb – Apr 2015); mobile development at Roadhouse Interactive and DeNA; MonoTizen, a Mono/.NET port to Tizen.

Programmer to Senior Software Engineer & Architect

Selected game credits: FIFA Football 2004 and 2005; FIFA 06 Road to FIFA World Cup; FIFA 07, 08, 10 and 11, including FIFA Ultimate Team; NBA Live 06; NHL 13–15; EA SPORTS UFC; EA SPORTS UFC Mobile.

- **NHL & UFC architecture, 2012–2014:** Software architect for TABU, building the first EA SPORTS UFC and NHL 15 on the shared Wireframe framework; then systems engineering on UFC Mobile.
- **EA SPORTS Label Software Architect, 2012:** First dedicated label architect; chaired the new Architecture Council, coordinating technical direction across EA SPORTS teams and platforms.
- **FIFA Advance team and studio technology, 2007–2012:** FIFA Advance team (2007–09): next-generation FIFA technology ahead of the shipping team, plus FIFA Ultimate Team; then EA Canada studio-wide tooling and architecture (2009–12) on the Basekit project: TechTracker, tracking game teams' package versioning and local diffs across 30+ workspaces and ~1,000 packages, used to drive convergence; Wireframe 2.0.
- **EATech, 2005–2007:** Company-wide configuration management (Framework2) in EA's central technology group. Helped modularise RenderWare into ~60 components with testing and compatibility support; built cross-platform build tooling and Visual Studio project generation adopted across EA.
- **FIFA and EA Canada / Orca CM, 2003–2005:** FIFA 2004's SourceSafe-to-Perforce migration; online lead for FIFA 2005 (first Xbox Live title). Technical lead of the Vancouver studio's configuration-management group for the Xbox 360 launch titles FIFA 06 Road to FIFA World Cup and NBA Live 06, as it grew from one team into a team-of-teams of three sub-leads with around fifteen engineers reporting to them. Interviewed candidates and mentored the group's engineers.
- **EA UK, 1999–2002:** Football systems on The FA Premier League Football Manager; built the scripting-language parser and bytecode runtime for Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets on PS2; Game Development Framework (2002), a cross-company collaboration project.

Psygnosis (Sony), Programmer, Leeds, UK (1996 – 1998): Prophecy and Global Domination (PC, PlayStation).

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

- **Local LLMs:** Hermes Agent running against a self-hosted Qwen 3.8 27B model, served by llama.cpp from a 2 x RTX 3090 + NVLink workstation and shared over Tailscale with several other Linux machines; always experimenting.
- **Early Days of Ethereum:** founder and host of the founding-era oral-history project; 14 interviews, 180+ profiles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

C++ (20+ years): PlayStation 1–4, Xbox generations, GameCube and PC; C#, Python, TypeScript; some Haskell. CMake, Perforce, Git, Jenkins, Docker, Unity; Claude Code, Codex and MCP; Linux, Windows and macOS.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science with Artificial Intelligence, University of Leeds, 1996